

c1 dd 00 01 09 00 |Two Sample Chapters|author=El
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c1 dd 00 01 — magic · type · tone · pipe-delimited beader

Two Sample Chapters

El Gólem
— —

ORDINARY · tone byte 0x00

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Dogecoin block 6,218,xxx

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On the Cord

A book is, in the protocol, a `oxo9` inscription whose body lists references to other quipus. Each reference carries a tag, a name, and a 32-byte `ref_txid`. The book is not the prose; the book is the manifest.¹

The cord runs from the root transaction through the strands; the knots on each strand are the `OP_RETURN`-bearing transactions; the join collects every strand's terminus into one output that returns the unused capital to the inscriber's address. This is the *diamond*.²

A book that points at another book is a library³ [a book of books, recursive by virtue of the type system]. The recursion is bounded by the reader's chosen depth limit; the project's default is eight levels, matching the binding alias-chain depth.

¹ The same essay rendered through two different books can present differently — each book's binding entries provide a contextual overlay (title rewrites, citations, annotations) without altering the inscribed prose.

On the Knot

Every knot is one transaction. Every transaction carries one OP_RETURN. Every OP_RETURN carries up to eighty bytes of payload. ⁴The Bitcoin / Dogecoin script primitive OP_RETURN provably-burns the output it appears in, signaling to validators that the eighty bytes following are data not value. The fee for emitting them is the same as any other transaction's fee: small. The total payload of an inscription is therefore the sum of its strand-knot OP_RETURNS, concatenated in strand order, parsed by the canonical type module corresponding to the inscription's type byte.

⁴ eighty bytes

Reading a quipu is following the cord. The reader fetches the root transaction, identifies its strand-seed outputs, walks each strand forward through its OP_RETURN-bearing knots, and concatenates the payloads. There is no global index; there is no central catalog. The chain is the catalog, and the catalog is the chain.

Citations of other quipus are written as *Dos ensayos* quipu:266715144169... in the inscribed prose. The reader resolves the citation by fetching the cited txid, parsing its header, and rendering or linking accordingly.

Notes

- ² on “*the diamond*”. Each diamond is one inscription: a splitter transaction with N outputs (one per strand), N parallel strand chains, and a single mega-join transaction collecting all the strand termini. The geometry is dictated by Dogecoin’s mempool ancestor limit of 25, which caps how long a single strand can be before requiring a block-confirmation wait.

note: This is a class-demonstration document. The txids above are placeholders and not inscribed on chain.

Unattached annotations

- *a phrase that doesn't appear in the prose*— This is what the unattached-annotation mechanism does: the inscriber's intent is preserved even when the anchor mismatches. The note surfaces here in the colophon rather than being silently dropped.